CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PODCAST PRODUCER IN THE AI ERA

Every niche has a podcast now — producers are the invisible people who make them sound expensive and ship on time.

★ **TL;DR — Median around $45K employed, remote, no credentials, learnable in 1–6 months. The catch: pay follows audience size, so the money is in serving established shows and businesses, not hobby podcasts.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

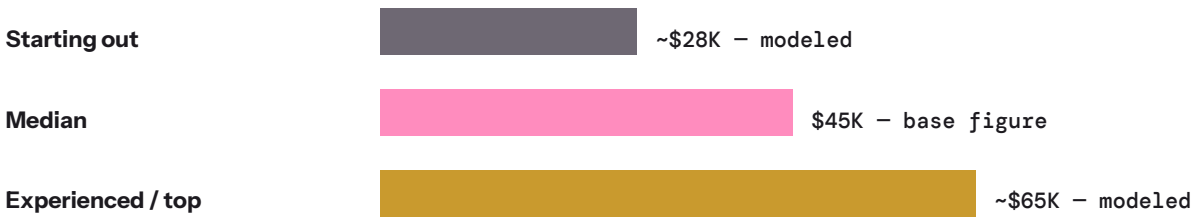
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- Production is a bundle: recording support, editing, show notes, clips, scheduling, publishing.
- Clients buy reliability — episodes that appear weekly, clean and on time, without being chased.
- AI cleans audio and drafts notes; editorial judgment and show sense stay human.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Podcast Producer is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PODCAST PRODUCER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Edit raw recordings: cut filler, fix levels, clean noise
- ✓ Cut short clips for social from each episode
- ✓ Write show notes, titles and descriptions that get clicked
- ✓ Manage the publishing calendar and the guests pipeline

Think: the stage manager of a radio show — the audience hears two people chatting; you built the illusion.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI removes silence and filler words, cleans audio to a decent standard, transcribes and drafts show notes. The mechanical edit is heavily automated.	Editorial ears: which story stays, which tangent dies, where the episode's real hook hides in minute 34. Taste and reliability stay human.

⚠ **Thousands of podcasts are hobbies with no budget. Sell to shows with sponsors, businesses with marketing budgets, and creators with products.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Remote, headphones-on, deep-work friendly ✓ You hear every conversation in your niche first ✓ Freelance stacking across several shows works well	✗ Weekly deadlines that never take a holiday ✗ Rush episodes are a lifestyle, not an exception ✗ Your name is never on the thing you made good

Good fit? You have good ears, editorial instincts and a producer's love of shipping on schedule. Bad fit? You want to be the voice — producers are heard only when something goes wrong.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — EDITORIAL PRODUCTION FREELANCE	DOOR B — BUSINESS PODCAST SERVICES
Learn one audio editor properly (Descript, Audition, Reaper), cut sample episodes from public raw recordings, and pitch established shows a free trial edit.	Companies run podcasts as marketing and hate producing them. Offer a full package — record support, edit, notes, clips, publish — priced monthly per show.

Smart move: Sell the clips, not the edit: shows grow from short-form cutdowns. A producer who delivers audience growth material gets retainers; a button-pusher gets replaced by software.

Where you land after: Senior producer → executive producer / podcast lead, or a production studio serving a niche.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
AUDIO EDITING	THE FULL	PORTFOLIO EPISODES	TRIAL-EDIT PITCHES	SYSTEMS AND	STACK SHOWS,

STEP 1 — Audio editing core

FREE–$30/MO · WEEKS 1–3

- One editor deeply: cleanup, leveling, pacing, loudness standards for platforms.
- Edit a full practice episode from raw to published quality.

STEP 2 — The full package skills

FREE · WEEKS 3–6

- Show notes, titles, chapters, audiograms and clip selection.
- Publishing workflow: hosting platforms, schedules, metadata.

STEP 3 — Portfolio episodes

FREE · MONTHS 1–2

- Produce 2–3 sample episodes end-to-end (with permission, from public raw audio or a volunteer host).
- Before/after audio samples sell better than descriptions.

STEP 4 — Trial-edit pitches

MONTHS 2–4

- Pitch mid-size shows one free re-edit of their last episode.
- Target shows with sponsors or products — that's where budgets live.

STEP 5 — Systems and speed

MONTHS 3–5

- Templates for notes, clips and publishing; batch your production days.
- Reliability systems are the product: checklists, backups, deadlines.

STEP 6 — Stack shows, raise rates

MONTHS 4–6

- Build to 3–5 retainer shows in one niche you understand.
- Raise per-episode rates as turnaround and clip quality become your brand.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: install your editor and clean up one raw recording — any long voice memo will do.

- Days 1–30: full episode produced from raw; loudness and pacing no longer mysteries.
- Days 31–60: package skills done; two sample episodes published with notes and clips.
- Days 61–90: trial-edit pitches sent; first paying show onboard or in trials.
- Day 90: samples, systems and outreach live — the retainer stack has begun.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ GREAT SHOWS SOUND EFFORTLESS. THAT'S THE JOB. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.